

The Navigation Bridge

The Navigation Bridge

Exercise 1

barometer	satellite aerial	navigating bridge
fire extinguisher	DGPS	echo sounder

Exercise 2

fire control plan	AIS	lifeboat
liferaft	Navtex Receiver	NLI

Exercise 3

radar	VDR	walkie-talkie	chart room
SART	EPIRB	helm	VHF

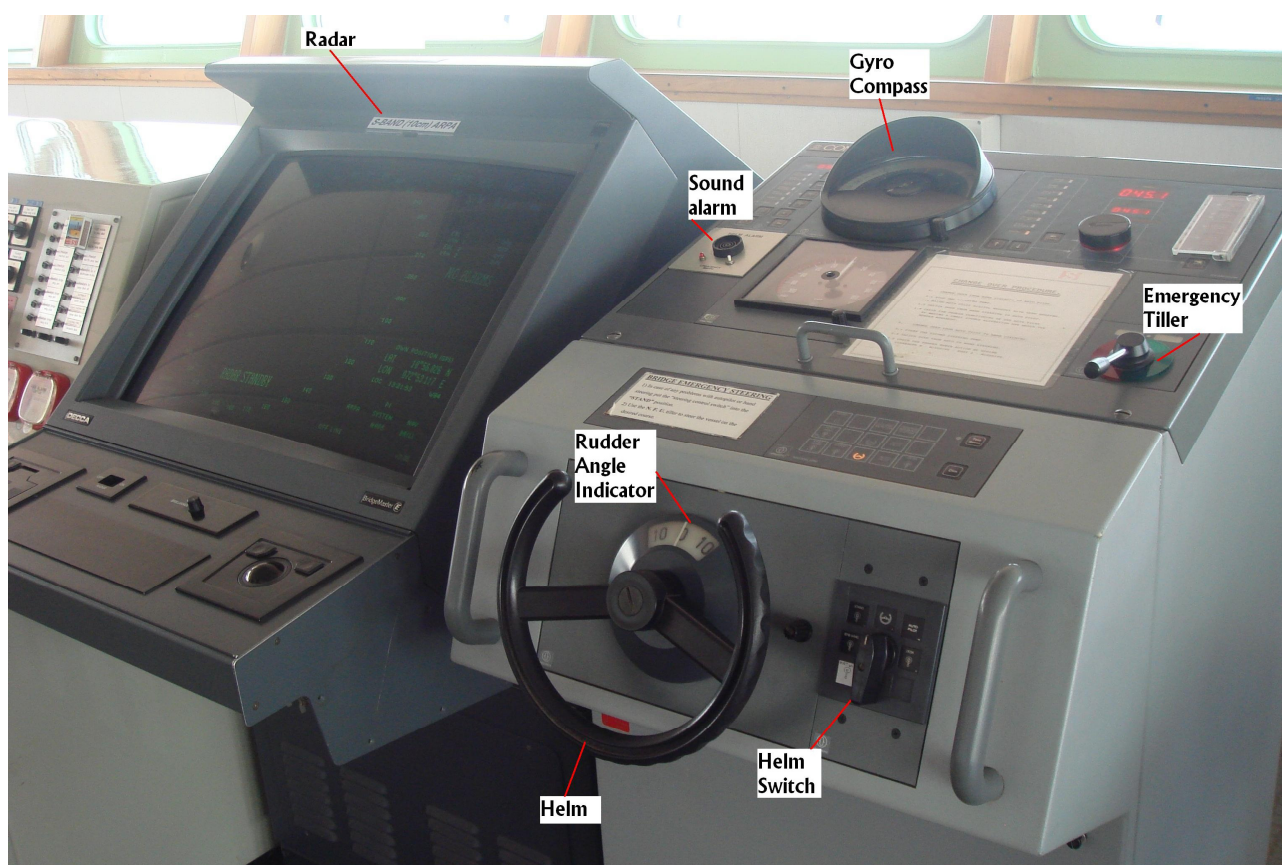
Exercise 4



1. This is a **torch**.
2. This is **the lights switchboard**.

3. This is **the fire alarm**.
4. This is **the emergency alarm**.
5. This is **the radiotelephone**.
6. This is **the internal phone**.

Exercise 5



Exercise 6



Automatic Identification System

It is used by ships and Vessel Traffic Services for identification and locating vessels.

Marine VHF Radiotelephone

It provides general communications in accordance with GMDSS requirements.

Steering gear pump

This device helps to move the rudder blade.

Controllable pitch propeller automatic recorder

It shows the propeller blade pitch.

Main engine emergency controls

They operate the main engine in emergency situations.

Controllable pitch propeller

It is a special type of propeller fitted with adjustable blades.

Tiller

A lever used to turn a rudder and steer a ship.

Bow Thruster

It assists ship handling by moving the bow or stern laterally.

Internal Phone

It provides communications within the ship.

Working as on AB on Board Ship**Exercise 1**

Listening comprehension (interview)

Texts:

Introduction***Can you introduce yourself?***

Hello! My name is Andrew Ivanov. I'm an AB on the Riga Star in the Latvian Shipping Company. I am 22 years old.

Since childhood I have been interested in boats, ships and maritime transport. I have always liked operating machines and learning new practical skills therefore I decided to enter the Riga Maritime School at the age of 15.

During my training I went to sea twice as a trainee. Once I had completed my maritime studies I started working for the Latvian Shipping Company as an AB. I love the sea and I enjoy my work very much. My duties as an AB include keeping watch during which I steer the vessel, perform lookout duties and help the Navigating Officer. I also carry out maintenance. As an AB I have to be able to operate deck machinery, such as the windlass or winches during mooring or unmooring operations. During cargo operations I have to operate cargo gear.

Working as a helmsman***Could you tell us more about steering the ship?***

Yes, sure. Every day I have to keep watch as a helmsman and lookout on the bridge. My duties are as follows: first of all, I take over the watch. Throughout my watch I have to keep a steady course and carry out all helm orders. I have to repeat all the helm orders to confirm that I have understood and carried them out correctly. I have to report immediately if the vessel does not answer the helm. I have to communicate with the Navigating Officers and sometimes with pilots using the correct navigational terms relating to heading and steering. For example, when the navigator asks me: „What is your heading?“, I answer: „My heading is 123 degrees“ or when he orders: „Hard a-port!“, it means I have to put the rudder fully over to port.

When the Officer of the Watch needs a course steered by compass, he gives me the direction in which he wants the wheel to be turned followed by each numeral separately, e.g. *Port, steer one eight two* or *Starboard, steer zero eight two*.

When I receive an order to steer, e.g. *182 degrees*, I repeat the order and bring the vessel round steadily to the course ordered. When the vessel is steady on the course ordered, I call out: *Steady on one eight two*. Then the Navigating Officer acknowledges my reply.

Sometimes I have to keep security watches, e.g. gangway watch or anchor watch while the ship is not underway.

Working as a lookout

What exactly do your lookout duties involve?

On the bridge I have to act as a competent lookout during daytime and in the hours of darkness. This means I have to observe the sea, looking for hazards, other ships, land, etc. I must report anything I see or hear. I must report to the Officer of the Watch on all ships in the vicinity, all navigation marks and lights, all floating objects, sightings of ice, derelicts and any other hazards to navigation. When reporting, I must give information on the bearing of the object, target angles, position angles and what the object is. I also have to be familiar with various types of distress signals that can be used at sea.

Maintenance duties

Do you do anything else, apart from working on the bridge?

Yes, of course, on board ship I also carry out maintenance duties. These include repair work, cleaning and the upkeep of equipment and areas in the Deck Department. They also involve maintenance of the ship's metal structures, such as chipping, scraping, cleaning, priming and painting to prevent corrosion and keep the ship in good condition. Areas such as the hull, decks, superstructure, cargo gear and the funnel frequently need maintenance. I also need to maintain the lifeboats, rescue boats and liferafts in good condition. Before painting the area must be cleaned by washing with a cleaning solution to remove all dirt and oil. Then I rinse the area with clean fresh water. If there is loose paint or scale, I scrape it off. If the rust is very heavy, I use a special hammer, which is called a chipping hammer. Finally, I clean the metal with a wire brush and coat it with primer paint.

Personal qualities and skills

In your opinion, what personal qualities and skills should an AB have?

To my mind, an AB must be a responsible and reliable person who wants to work well without constant supervision. As a sailor I am away from home regularly. I miss my home and friends but I have a good working relationship with my fellow shipmates. Sometimes I have to spend long periods aboard ship in the company of a small crew.

An AB must often work outdoors in any weather. I am strong and enjoy doing practical and physically active work.

As a person I am flexible and I do not mind undertaking a variety of tasks. I do not mind getting my hands messy or dirty and I enjoy using tools and equipment. I have always had an interest in maintaining machinery.

To perform my duties properly, I need to have good eyesight and hearing. Being a sailor requires good health and fitness. I need to pass a medical examination regularly. I must effectively use all available instruments and equipment needed to carry out lookout duties, particularly taking bearings of approaching ships. All ABs must be fit because we have to work shifts, including nights. I enjoy working in a team and cooperating with other crewmembers. We carry out orders and complete tasks set by the Officers.

Exercise 2

My **name** is Andrew Ivanov.

I'm an AB on the Riga Star in the Latvian **Shipping** Company.

I am 22 years **old**.

Since childhood I have been interested **in** boats, ships and maritime transport.

I have always liked operating machines and learning new practical skills therefore I decided to **enter** the Riga Maritime School at the **age** of 15.

During my training I went to **sea** two times as a trainee.

When I left Maritime School I started **working** for the Latvian Shipping Company as an AB.

I love the sea and I **enjoy** my work very much.

My duties as an AB include keeping **watch** during which I steer the vessel, do lookout duties and help the Navigating Officer.

I also **do** maintenance.

As an AB I have to be able to operate **deck** machinery, such as the windlass or winches during mooring or unmooring operations.

During **cargo** operations I have to operate cargo gear.

Exercise 3

bridge	<place from which a ship is steered>
heavy	<great in amount, degree>
team	<group of people working together>
course	<route>

Exercise 4

pilot	<person guiding ships through difficulties>
heading	<direction of ship>
port	<left hand side of ship>
deck	<horizontal structure in ship>